Account Security

Knowledge document for the AI Digital Safety & Scam Prevention Assistant

Core safety rule: Never share your password, OTP, PIN, recovery code, or full payment-card security details with anyone. Genuine support staff should not need you to disclose these secrets.

1. Why account security matters

Email, social-media, messaging, shopping, and banking accounts can contain private information and may be used to reset other accounts. Criminals may try to take control by stealing passwords or OTPs, tricking users into approving sign-ins, abusing password reuse, or persuading users to install malicious software.

2. Common account-security threats

OTP theft

A caller or message asks you to reveal a one-time password, verification code, or login code. Sharing it can allow another person to complete a sign-in or transaction.

Password phishing

A fake login page or message asks you to enter your password. The page may imitate a real service.

Password reuse

Using the same password across websites means a password exposed on one service may put other accounts at risk.

Account recovery abuse

Someone tries to change recovery email/phone details or tricks you into approving a password reset.

Unexpected sign-in approval

You receive a login notification or multi-factor authentication prompt that you did not initiate.

Malicious app or remote access

An unknown person asks you to install an app, share your screen, or grant accessibility or device-control permissions.

SIM or phone-number takeover

A criminal may attempt to take control of your mobile number to intercept calls or messages. Unexpected loss of service or unexplained SIM changes should be investigated with your mobile provider.

3. Build stronger account protection

• Use a long, unique password or passphrase for every important account. A reputable password manager can help create and store unique passwords.

• Enable multi-factor authentication (MFA) where available. Prefer passkeys or authenticator-based methods when supported and appropriate.

• Never approve an MFA prompt you did not initiate. Deny it and change your password through the service's official app or website if you suspect an attack.

• Keep your phone, computer, browser, and apps updated. Install apps only from trusted official stores and review requested permissions.

• Secure your primary email account because it may be used to reset other accounts. Review recovery email addresses, phone numbers, active sessions, and connected apps.

• Use device screen locks and avoid signing in to sensitive accounts on shared or untrusted devices. Sign out when finished.

• Do not share OTPs, passwords, PINs, recovery codes, or remote-access permissions with callers or people in chats.

• Access services through their official app or by typing a known website address instead of following unexpected login links.

4. What to do if you receive an unexpected OTP or login prompt

• Do not share the code or approve the prompt.

• Do not click links in the alert message. Open the service through its official app or website.

• Check account activity, active sessions, and security settings if the service provides them.

• If you did not request the code, consider changing the password from the official site and review recovery methods.

• If the alert concerns a bank or payment account, contact the bank or provider through official channels if you suspect unauthorized access.

5. If you think an account has been compromised

• Use a trusted device and the service's official app/site to change the password immediately, if you can still access the account.

• Change the password on any other account where you reused it, starting with email and financial accounts.

• Sign out unknown sessions, remove unfamiliar connected apps, and verify recovery email addresses and phone numbers.

• Enable MFA or a passkey, and save recovery codes in a secure place. Never send recovery codes to another person.

• If you are locked out, use the service's official account-recovery process. Do not pay an unofficial recovery agent.

• If banking details, payment credentials, or money are involved, contact your bank/payment provider immediately. In India, report suspected financial cyber fraud by calling 1930 and follow the instructions at https://cybercrime.gov.in/.

• Preserve evidence such as security alerts, emails, screenshots, timestamps, and transaction references. Do not include passwords or OTPs in your evidence shared with others.

6. Example scenarios

Scenario A: Unexpected OTP. You receive a login code you did not request. **Safer response:** Do not share it. Open the service through its official app/site, check account activity, and secure the account if needed.

Scenario B: Caller claims to be support. Someone asks for your password or OTP to protect your account. **Safer response:** End the conversation and contact the service using independently verified official contact details.

Scenario C: Account takeover. You see an unfamiliar login or your recovery email has changed. **Safer response:** Use the official recovery process, secure your email account, revoke unknown sessions, and contact the service's official support.

7. What the AI assistant can and cannot conclude

The assistant can recommend common security steps, but it cannot determine from a short message alone whether an account is compromised. Users should check security alerts and account activity in the official service and contact verified support when needed.

8. Reference sources

• **CERT-In Awareness Booklets:** https://www.cert-in.org.in/AwarenessBooklets.jsp

• **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal:** https://cybercrime.gov.in/

• **Google Account Security Checkup:** https://myaccount.google.com/security

• **Microsoft Account Security:** https://account.microsoft.com/security

Maintenance note: Educational summary for a prototype knowledge base. Official settings and recovery processes vary by service; verify current instructions from the service provider. Last reviewed: 10 October 2026.